

Sterling Tower, Business Bay - 2BR Rent Analysis

Prepared for: Sajida / Wellspring

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Subject: whether AED 180,000/year is still the right rent level for a 2-bedroom in The Sterling, Business Bay

Executive Verdict

AED 180,000/year for a 2-bedroom in The Sterling is not obviously overpriced if the apartment is furnished, high floor, in good condition, and has a real Burj Khalifa / Downtown / canal view. It sits around the current market centre for better Sterling 2BR stock.

However, it is not a bargain. Current market evidence shows that Sajida should be able to test the market for a better deal, especially if she can move existing furniture into another apartment.

Recommended negotiation/search position:

- Target deal: AED 150,000-160,000/year for an unfurnished or lightly furnished 2BR where her furniture can be reused.
- Acceptable deal: AED 160,000-170,000/year for a clean 2BR with a good view and practical layout.
- Pay up to AED 175,000-180,000/year only if the unit has a strong view, good furnishing/condition, and better revenue potential.
- Avoid: paying AED 185,000-200,000/year for a small 1,123 sqft 2BR unless the view, furnishing, guest appeal and expected ADR clearly justify it.

The practical recommendation is not "move at any price". The move only makes sense if she can either:

1. Save at least AED 20,000-30,000/year on a comparable unit; or
2. Keep a similar rent but improve view, building position, unit condition or revenue potential enough to increase nightly rate and occupancy.

Current Sterling Market Evidence

The Sterling East - active / recent listing evidence

Property Finder showed an active 2BR listing in The Sterling East at AED 190,000/year:

- 2 bedrooms, 3 bathrooms
- 1,123 sqft
- Fully furnished
- High floor
- Burj Khalifa view
- Available from 5 June 2026

- Property Finder price insight: this listing was 14% above the listed average, with average rent shown as AED 166,919.

This confirms that AED 190,000 is the top end for a small but high-view / furnished 2BR in Sterling East, not the normal target price.

Property Finder also showed recent rental transactions in The Sterling East:

Date	Rent	Size
16 Jul 2026	AED 170,000	1,690 sqft
23 Jun 2026	AED 155,000	1,123 sqft
11 May 2026	AED 200,000	1,665 sqft
8 May 2026	AED 180,000	1,690 sqft
10 Mar 2026	AED 180,000	1,684 sqft

This transaction set is important. It suggests that AED 180,000 can be fair for a larger 1,680-1,690 sqft 2BR, while a smaller 1,123 sqft unit can transact closer to AED 155,000 unless the view/finish is exceptional.

Bayut and portal search evidence

Bayut search snippets showed:

- The Sterling East 2BR average around AED 176,113.
- The Sterling West 2BR average around AED 176,368.
- The Sterling overall 2BR average around AED 183,438.
- Sterling West 2BR listings between about AED 159,880 and AED 175,000.
- A Sterling West furnished 2BR with Burj Khalifa view at AED 160,000/year, 1,123 sqft.
- A Sterling East spacious 2BR in Business Bay around AED 150,000/year, 1,690 sqft, from Bayut search snippets.

Bayut pages were partly blocked by captcha during direct fetch, so the Bayut points should be treated as listing-search evidence, not final signed transaction proof.

Business Bay / Downtown substitute evidence

The replacement market matters because Sajida may move furniture to another unit instead of accepting the existing rent.

Relevant search signals:

- Business Bay furnished 2BR averages are broad, often around AED 160,000-180,000 depending on building, view and finish.
- Peninsula / newer Business Bay stock shows 2BR Burj/canal-view options around AED 160,000-180,000.
- Burj Views, Downtown Dubai, showed furnished or upgraded 2BR options around AED 135,000-170,000 in search snippets.
- South Ridge, Downtown Dubai, showed 2BR options around AED 160,000-185,000 depending on furnishing, view and layout.

- Downtown Views II and Burj Royale can show 2BR options around AED 150,000-190,000, but the best Burj-view units often move higher.

This means The Sterling is not automatically the only logical tower. If Sajida can get a better Downtown-side position, better view, or larger layout near AED 160,000-175,000, it is worth considering.

Rent Range Guidance

For a 2BR in The Sterling / immediate Business Bay-Downtown edge:

Unit type	Fair annual rent range	Comment
Smaller 2BR, weak/no special view	AED 145,000-155,000	Best target if moving own furniture
Smaller 2BR, furnished, good view	AED 155,000-170,000	Good replacement range
Larger 2BR, good layout/view	AED 165,000-180,000	AED 180k is defensible here
Premium high-floor / upgraded / strong Burj view	AED 180,000-200,000	Pay only if revenue upside supports it

Is Sajida's AED 180,000 Rent Good Or Bad?

It depends on the exact unit.

AED 180,000 is fair if:

- the unit is closer to 1,650-1,700 sqft;
- it has a clear Burj Khalifa, Downtown or attractive canal view;
- the furnishing is high quality and guest-ready;
- the layout photographs well for short-term rental;
- the building/unit condition reduces maintenance friction;
- the rent includes favourable payment terms or reduced upfront pressure.

AED 180,000 is weak if:

- the unit is around 1,100-1,150 sqft;
- the view is ordinary;
- the furniture is not important because she can move her own;
- there are similar Sterling / Downtown-edge options at AED 150,000-165,000;
- the landlord will not negotiate.

Move-Furniture Strategy

Moving furniture can make sense because furniture gives Sajida leverage. She does not need to overpay for a fully furnished landlord unit if she already has usable guest-ready furniture.

Target search brief:

- 2BR in The Sterling East / West, Burj Views, South Ridge, Downtown Views II, Peninsula, or comparable Downtown-Business Bay edge.
- Prefer unfurnished or lightly furnished.
- Size target: 1,300 sqft+ if possible; 1,100 sqft acceptable only with excellent view/location.
- View target: Burj Khalifa, canal, Downtown skyline, or open view.
- Rent target: AED 150,000-165,000.
- Hard ceiling: AED 170,000 unless view/position materially improves revenue potential.
- Avoid moving into weaker location/view just for a small rent saving.

Financial Decision Rule

The move has hidden costs:

- agent commission, often around 5%;
- security deposit, usually 5-10%;
- moving cost and furniture handling;
- possible minor maintenance/setup work;
- listing/photo refresh;
- downtime or transition friction if this is operated as a short-term rental.

Because of that, a move for only AED 5,000-10,000/year saving is usually not worth it.

Recommended rule:

- Saving below AED 15,000/year: usually renegotiate current unit instead of moving.
- Saving AED 20,000-30,000/year: move becomes worth serious consideration if the replacement is comparable.
- Same rent but better view/location: consider only if revenue forecast improves enough to justify the operational effort.
- Worse view/location: do not move unless the rent saving is substantial.

Recommended Message To Sajida

Sajida, I checked the current Sterling / Business Bay 2BR market. AED 180k is not crazy for a good Sterling 2BR, especially if it has a strong view and good furnishing, but it is not a bargain either. There are market signals around AED 150k-165k for comparable or partially/unfurnished options, and around AED 160k-175k for some furnished good-view units.

My recommendation is to use AED 180k as the ceiling, not the target. If you can move your furniture, we should search for a similar or better-view 2BR at AED 150k-165k. If we find one, the rent saving could justify moving. If the saving is only AED 5k-10k, it is probably better to renegotiate your current unit unless the new apartment has much better revenue potential.

Sources Checked

- Property Finder listing: The Sterling East, fully furnished 2BR, 1,123 sqft, high floor, Burj Khalifa view, AED 190,000/year. URL: <https://www.propertyfinder.ae/en/plp/rent/apartment-for-rent-dubai-business-bay-the-sterling-the-sterling-east-99136332.html>

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- Bayut search: 2BR apartments in South Ridge, Downtown Dubai. URL: <https://www.bayut.com/to-rent/2-bedroom-apartments/dubai/downtown-dubai/south-ridge>

Caveats

This is a market-pricing and decision-support note based on live portal evidence and visible transaction/listing data. Final decision should be made after checking the exact apartment size, view, furnishing condition, payment terms, availability date, landlord flexibility, and short-term-rental forecast for the specific replacement unit.